

Types of Sentences (Function Based)

Declarative or Assertive Sentence

A declarative sentence "declares" or states a fact, opinion, convey ideas, observation, explanations. Declarative sentences can be either positive or negative. A declarative sentence ends with a period (.).

Example: I'll meet you at the train station.
The sun rises in the East.
He doesn't get up early.

Imperative Sentence

An imperative sentence is a sentence that expresses a command, an order, or a request. The imperative takes no subject and always starts with a main verb. The imperative form ends with either a period (.).

Example: Open the door.
Finish your homework
Pick up that mess.

Interrogative Sentence

The interrogative asks a question. In the interrogative form, the auxiliary verb precedes the subject which is then followed by the main verb (i.e., Are you coming?). These sentences often begin with who, when, what, where, why and how. The interrogative form ends with a question mark (?).

Example: How long have you lived in France?
When does the bus leave?
Do you enjoy listening to classical music?

Exclamatory Sentence

Exclamatory sentences are used to express strong feelings and emotions like happiness, excitement, anger, disbelief, etc. The exclamatory always ends with an exclamation mark (!).

Example: Hurry up!
That sounds fantastic!
I can't believe you said that!

Exercise 1: Read the following sentences and mark whether Declarative, Interrogative, Imperative or Exclamatory.

1. Do you drink milk daily? _____
2. Stars are twinkling in the sky. _____
3. Ah, what a lovely rose! _____
4. Let us go for a river bath. _____
5. Keep quiet! _____
6. The train is not running on time. _____
7. Where has Rohan gone? _____
8. Call in the doctor, please. _____
9. Kindly lend me your book. _____
10. I like this book. _____
11. How beautiful a street is in winter! _____
12. Have the skillet hot and keep it well greased. _____
13. We boarded our train with feelings of unbounded relief. _____
14. Each cell measured about ten feet by ten. _____
15. Where were the blackbirds? _____
16. Always obey your parents, when they are present. _____
17. The house was so big. _____
18. How beautiful the mountains are! _____
19. Do you remember all of your dreams? _____
20. We won! _____
21. How can any deny themselves the pleasure of my company? _____
22. He was exceedingly poor, wearing only a ragged shirt and trousers. _____
23. Sit down quietly. _____
24. I looked tired, but my complexion was good. _____
25. Not a man in London made a better boot! _____

Homework:

Exercise 2: Read the following sentences and mark whether Declarative, Interrogative, Imperative or Exclamatory.

1. Please shut the windows and doors. _____
2. Do you like chocolate pastries? _____
3. My name is Astrid Gracy. _____
4. Where are you going? _____
5. Such a beautiful place! _____
6. Go and try this new flavour. _____
7. Today is gloomy weather. _____
8. Please clean your cupboard today. _____
9. Turn off all the lights and fans when you leave the room. _____
10. May I come in? _____
11. How would you like your coffee? _____
12. I love reading storybooks. _____

13. Never tell lies. _____
14. The Earth revolves around the Sun. _____
15. Alas! We lost the trophy. _____

Types of Sentences (Structure Based)

Simple Sentences

Simple sentences contain no conjunction (i.e., and, but, or, etc.).

Example: Frank ate his dinner quickly.
Peter and Sue visited the museum last Saturday.
Are you coming to the party?

Compound Sentences

Compound sentences contain two statements that are connected by coordinating conjunctions (i.e., and, but, or, so, yet, for, nor.) and a comma.

Example: I wanted to come, but it was late.
The company had an excellent year, so they gave everyone a bonus.
I went shopping, and my wife went to her classes.

Complex Sentences

Complex sentences contain a dependent clause and at least one independent clause. The two clauses are connected by subordinate conjunctions (i.e, which, who, although, despite, if, unless, since, because, even though, after, whenever, wherever etc.).

Example: My daughter, who was late for class, arrived shortly after the bell rang.
That's the man who bought our house
Although it was difficult, the class passed the test with excellent marks.

Compound-Complex Sentences

Compound-complex sentences contain at least one dependent clause and more than one independent clause. The clauses are connected by both coordinating conjunctions (i.e., and, but, or, so, yet, for, nor.) and subordinate conjunctions (i.e, which, who, although, despite, if, unless, since, because, even though, after, whenever, wherever etc.).

Example: John, who briefly visited last month, won the prize, and he took a short vacation.
Jack forgot his friend's birthday, so he sent him a card when he finally remembered.
The report which Tom compiled was presented to the board, but it was rejected because it was too complex.

Exercise 1: Identify simple , compound , complex, and compound-complex sentences.

1. Our coach will host a pizza party when we win our first game.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
2. Olivia and Caroline went to the movies.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
3. Although I broke my arm, I still cheered for my team from the sidelines.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
4. The man who was on the other side of the street waved, so I looked at him.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
5. James grilled burgers, and Patrick made a salad.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
6. Susie called her friend on the phone.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
7. Since I made the honour roll, my parents let me have a friend spend the night.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
8. Before Alice called me, she called her mom, and her mom asked her to babysit her brother.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
9. I waited for the bus, but it was late.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
10. Jennifer sat in her chair, which was a dark red recliner, and she read all evening.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
11. The young students enjoyed the game.

- a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
12. We met rather few people who spoke English.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
13. I have been on rather too many planes and trains recently.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
14. We drove right up to Helsinki in two days.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
15. I don't care how expensive it is.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
16. Two minutes ago the child was fast asleep, but now he is wide awake.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
17. He is not tall enough to be a soldier.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
18. She was tired, and she was still hungry even though she had eaten lunch.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
19. I have got four sisters and each of them is quite different from the others.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
20. You can either come with me now or walk home.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
21. He will never leave home because he hasn't got the courage to.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
22. When all else fails, read the user manual.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
23. It was Sam who paid for the drinks.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
24. She took out her umbrella because it was raining, and then she walked home.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex
25. I don't like exercising, but I'll do it if I have to.
a) simple b) compound c) complex d) compound-complex

Exercise 2: Identify simple , compound , complex, and compound-complex sentences.

1. She didn't realize that she was making a mistake. _____
2. Where have you been all this while? _____
3. I don't know the answer. _____
4. She said that she wanted to go. _____
5. Rahul is not only clever but also industrious. _____
6. Neither this answer nor that answer is correct. _____
7. He was angry because she had lied to him. _____
8. I will try until I succeed. _____
9. Standing on tip-toe, he reached for the mango. _____
10. As they haven't arrived yet, we will go without them. _____